



Mark Scheme (Results)

November 2025

Pearson Edexcel International GCSE in

English Literature (4ET1)

Paper 1: Poetry and Modern Prose

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General Marking Guidance

- All candidates must receive the same treatment. Examiners must mark the first candidate in exactly the same way as they mark the last.
- Mark schemes should be applied positively. Candidates must be rewarded for what they have shown they can do rather than penalised for omissions.
- Examiners should mark according to the mark scheme not according to their perception of where the grade boundaries may lie.
- There is no ceiling on achievement. All marks on the mark scheme should be used appropriately.
- All the marks on the mark scheme are designed to be awarded. Examiners should always award full marks if deserved, i.e. if the answer matches the mark scheme. Examiners should also be prepared to award zero marks if the candidate's response is not worthy of credit according to the mark scheme.
- Where some judgement is required, mark schemes will provide the principles by which marks will be awarded and exemplification may be limited.
- When examiners are in doubt regarding the application of the mark scheme to a candidate's response, the team leader must be consulted.
- Crossed out work should be marked UNLESS the candidate has replaced it with an alternative response.

Specific Marking Guidance

When deciding how to reward an answer, examiners should consult both the indicative content and the associated marking grid(s). When using a levels-based mark scheme, the 'best fit' approach should be used.

- Examiners should first decide which descriptor most closely matches the answer and place it in that level.
- The mark awarded within the level will be decided based on the quality of the answer and will be modified according to how securely all bullet points are displayed at that level.
- Indicative content is exactly that – they are factual points that candidates are likely to use to construct their answer.
- It is possible for an answer to be constructed without mentioning some or all of these points, as long as they provide alternative responses to the indicative content that fulfils the requirements of the question. It is the examiner's responsibility to apply their professional judgement to the candidate's response in determining if the answer fulfils the requirements of the question.

Placing a mark within a level

- Examiners should first decide which descriptor most closely matches the answer and place it in that level. The mark awarded within the level will be decided based on the quality of the answer and will be modified according to how securely all bullet points are displayed at that level.
- In cases of uneven performance, the points above will still apply. Candidates will be placed in the level that best describes their answer according to the descriptors in that level. Marks will be awarded towards the top or bottom of that level depending on how they have evidenced each of the descriptor bullet points.
- If the candidate's answer meets the requirements fully, markers should be prepared to award full marks within the level. The top mark in the level is used for work that is as good as can realistically be expected within that level.

AO1	Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement.
AO2	Analyse the language, form and structure used by a writer to create meanings and effects.
AO3	Explore links and connections between texts.
AO4	Show understanding of the relationships between texts and the contexts in which they were written.

Section A – Unseen Poetry

Question number	Indicative content
1	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the text. Evidence of a degree of personal response must be given. It is not sufficient to summarise or paraphrase, nor is it sufficient simply to list literary devices. The writer's descriptive skills: - the writer describes observing a painter setting-up his equipment to paint a landscape picture: 'The mountains pose for him' - the scene is presented as a family group of mountains posing for their portrait to be completed for inclusion in the 'pleasant formality / Of the family album' - the painter's brush, described as a humming-bird, captures the colour. This imagery is used and implied throughout the poem: 'puddles of pigment / Bloom', 'wide blue screen', 'low green foot-hills', 'Blue Mountain Peak' - the sky is described as a cinematographer's or photographer's back screen, 'wide blue screen'. (A blue screen is used as a monochrome background colour and is a preferred choice to protect images from colour spill) - the artist is sincerely frustrated with trying to capture the scene, which is described with the contradictory 'Artlessly frustrating / The painter's art'. The oxymoron (and polyptoton), 'Changelessly changing', clearly illustrates the artist's frustration and the artist's state of mind - the writer admires the painter's skill when using the positive adverb 'Meticulously' and ends with acknowledging 'The painter's art'. The writer's choice of language: - personification is used throughout the poem with the easel 'straddling precariously', 'The mountains pose for him', 'foot-hills / Sprawl like grandchildren', 'seated elders', 'aloof ... / Blue Mountain Peak', 'impatiently waiting', 'little hills fidgeting' 'straddling precariously' suggests the artist is in a dangerous position, but could also reflect his determination - the painter's brush is described metaphorically as 'A tireless humming-bird'; its movements mirror those of the bird with the triplet: 'Dips, darts, hovers now here, now there' - the paint palette is compared to a garden: 'puddles of pigment / Bloom in the palette's wild small garden' - the mountains are a 'family group' posing for the painter. The elders, or larger mountains, are 'Dignified, self-conscious'; the younger hills are described with the simile 'Sprawl like grandchildren about the knees / Of seated elders', suggesting their careless and uncontrolled manner. The biggest and most impressive mountain, 'patriarchal in serenity', is the 'Blue Mountain Peak' - the imagery of the humming-bird is repeated. Towards the beginning of the poem, the painter works quickly as he 'Dips, [and] darts', but towards the end,

	the paintbrush is 'Meticulously poised' as the painter tries to capture the moment. The writer's use of form and structure: • first-person narrative immediately engages the reader, as we observe and appreciate the painter's art at the same time as the writer: 'I watch him set up easel' • the artist's exact position is described with the contrasting 'corner of the twisted, climbing / Mountain track'. As the track is twisted, it will lack sharp corners but will have several bends • plosives, 'professional', 'positions', 'perfect', 'preparedness' and 'pleasant', in quick succession echo the painter's frustration when waiting 'to confine them' • the ellipsis suggests that the paintbrush is poised for some time before the artist can continue. The scene must settle before the painter can proceed • the repetition of root words (polyptoton), 'Changelessly changing' and 'Artlessly ... art', add to the rhythm of the poem, with three lines in succession ending with continuous present participles. These examples are suggestions only. Accept any valid responses.
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Level	Mark	AO2 Analyse the language, form and structure used by a writer to create meanings and effects. (20 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–4	• The response is simple and the identification of language, form and structure used by the writer is minimal. • Limited use of relevant examples in support.
Level 2	5–8	• The response may be largely descriptive, with some comment on the language, form and structure used by the writer. • Some use of relevant examples to support the response.
Level 3	9–12	The response shows an understanding of the range of language, form and structure used by the writer and links these to their effect on the reader. Use of clearly relevant examples to support the response.
Level 4	13–16	The response is focused and detailed, and the analysis of the language, form and structure used by the writer and their effect on the reader is sustained. Use of fully relevant examples to support the response.
Level 5	17–20	The response is a cohesive evaluation of the interrelationship of the language, form and structure used by the writer and their effect on the reader. Discriminating use of relevant examples to support the response.

Section B – Anthology Poetry

Question number	Indicative content
2	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on comparison of the two poems. Evidence of a degree of personal response must be given. It is not sufficient to summarise or paraphrase, nor is it sufficient simply to list literary devices. <i>Search For My Tongue</i> (AO2) Responses may include: - the writer speaks about cultural issues and the difficulties experienced when trying to remember her 'mother tongue'. At times she thinks that she has forgotten it ('lost my tongue') but 'it grows back': 'Every time I think I've forgotten, ... / it blossoms out of my mouth' - the writer speaks directly to the reader in a conversational tone, as if answering a question about cultural issues: 'You ask me what I mean' - the poem considers the cultural issue of speaking and thinking in two languages: English and Gujarati; Gujarati is the poet's 'mother tongue'. The phrase 'lost my tongue' is a metaphor commonly meaning 'temporarily unable to speak', but here it is used as forgetting one's language - the writer speaks of the difficulties of having 'two tongues in your mouth'. The 'tongue' is used both literally for the organ in the mouth and metaphorically for the languages spoken with it. The speaker fears that her original language is forgotten as it 'would rot / rot and die' when not used as much as the alien 'foreign tongue' - there is a suggestion that the writer's true cultural identity has been suppressed, because living in a foreign country 'you had to / speak a foreign tongue' - the repetition of 'spit it out' suggests that the original language and cultural identity of the writer are now no use to her, unlike the 'foreign tongue' - the writer uses an extended metaphor in the second part of the poem to describe how, in her dreams, her 'mother' language is a bud that 'grows back', 'pushes the other tongue aside' and 'blossoms out of' her mouth - the poem is structured in three parts: in the first part, the difficulty of having two languages and not using her 'mother tongue' is expressed; in the second part, ideas are conveyed in Gujarati together with a phonetic version; in the final part, the Gujarati section is translated and suggests that the 'mother tongue' remains and 'grows' stronger in her dreams. The writer recollects her cultural issues in an affectionate way when it 'blossoms'. <i>Half-caste</i> (AO2) Responses may include: - the writer voices his anger and frustration about the cultural issue of prejudice and how members of society persist in using the outdated, derogatory and insulting phrase 'half-caste'

- the writer uses analogies of things that are half-and-half but are admired. He gives three examples of other mixtures of colours that could be considered 'half-caste', if all mixed colours were to be treated consistently. The examples are those of a Picasso canvas or the black and white keys of the piano for a Tchaikovsky symphony. He even refers to the changeable English weather, using a pun to describe how the mixture of sun and cloud changes to 'overcast'. The writer mocks the use of the phrase, 'half-caste', and shows how mixing things together is creative and natural
- the writer expresses his concerns about cultural issues; it is implied that language is used to control and discriminate against some members of society. He suggests that people need to open their minds to what the phrase, 'half-caste', connotes, and challenges them to use their whole minds to understand the whole story
- the phrase 'half-caste' is explored literally with all its implications, such as 'standing on one leg', shaking with 'half-a-hand' and communicating half a story
- the writer addresses the reader directly: 'Explain yuself', 'I will tell yu'
- the use of non-standard, colloquial English and modified Afro-Caribbean patois conveys the writer's thoughts and feelings about society: 'half of mih eye'
- repetition of commands, questions and answers, such as the imperative 'Explain yuself' and the question 'wha yu mean', helps bind the poem together
- the lack of punctuation, apart from dashes and obliques, together with the phonetic spelling, creates a sense of the spoken voice
- the use of the expletive, 'ah rass', emphasises the writer's tone of anger and frustration with cultural issues and prejudice
- the structure of the poem is in sections: the first half deals with the writer's questioning the implications for other things that are mixed, if the phrase is used consistently; the second sees him questioning the implications for himself and other people.

Both poems

Both poems have particular merits and features and therefore there are a number of points of comparison which students will make. Examiners might consider the following areas of comparison where applicable: treatment of subject matter and theme, tone, voice, attitude, character, diction, imagery including figurative language, poetic form/structure including rhythm, line length, enjambement.

All points of comparison should be developed and supported by close reference and evaluation of specific examples.

(AO3) Responses may include:

- both poems consider concerns about cultural issues. Bhatt is concerned that she may have lost her 'mother tongue', whereas Agard is frustrated and angry over the use of the term 'half-caste'. Bhatt's poem expresses her own feelings about her cultural issues, whereas Agard's personal and emotional poem is

	directed at the use of the phrase 'half-caste' used by other people who have prejudiced views • both poets use phonetic language. Bhatt includes Gujarati, with each line given a phonetic translation in parenthesis to aid the reader. Agard uses phonetics and modified patois to demonstrate his aggravation with society and pride in his own heritage • both poets structure their poems in sections and both use repetition • both poems refer to dreams. Bhatt regains her 'mother tongue' in her dream: 'overnight while I dream'. Agard mocks both himself and others who use the term 'half-caste' when he dreams 'half-a-dream'. These examples are suggestions only. Accept any valid responses.
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Level	Mark	AO2 Analyse the language, form and structure used by a writer to create meanings and effects. (15 marks) AO3 Explore links and connections between texts. (15 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–6	• The response is simple and the identification of language, form and structure used by the writer is minimal. • There is little or no comparison of the two poems. • Limited use of relevant examples in support.
Level 2	7–12	• The response may be largely descriptive, with some comment on the language, form and structure used by the writer. • There are some underdeveloped comparisons and contrasts presented, with obvious similarities and/or differences between the poems. • Some use of relevant examples to support the response. NB: the mark awarded cannot progress beyond the top of Level 2 if only ONE poem has been considered.
Level 3	13–18	The response shows an understanding of the range of language, form and structure used by the writer and links these to their effect on the reader. The response compares and contrasts a range of points and considers some similarities and/or differences between the poems. Use of clearly relevant examples to support the response.
Level 4	19–24	The response is focused and detailed, and the analysis of the language, form and structure used by the writer and their effect on the reader is sustained. The response compares and contrasts the poems effectively, considering a wide range of similarities and/or differences between the poems. Use of fully relevant examples to support the response.
Level 5	25–30	The response is a cohesive evaluation of the interrelationship of the language, form and structure used by the writer and their effect on the reader. The response compares and contrasts the poems perceptively with a varied and comprehensive range of similarities and/or differences between the poems. Discriminating use of relevant examples to support the response.

Question number	Indicative content
3	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on comparison of the two poems. Indicative content is offered for <i>Sonnet 116</i> but, because candidates are asked to choose any other appropriate poem from the selection, it is not always possible to indicate content for the second except in generic ways. <i>Sonnet 116</i> (AO2) Responses may include: • Shakespeare conveys his thoughts about a loving relationship and the nature of true love. The reference to the 'marriage of true minds' suggests that a really loving relationship is lasting and never changes: 'Love alters not' • the sonnet begins with a reminder of the traditional vows made at a Christian marriage, referring to 'impediments'. A loving relationship will not 'Admit impediments' • relationships and the durability of true love are emphasised through repeated words: 'love is not love / Which alters when it alteration finds / Or bends with the remover to remove' • it is suggested in a metaphor that love is a guide in a loving relationship and love is as precious and constant as 'an ever-fixèd mark', the 'star to every wandering bark' • Shakespeare suggests that true love can survive any storms or difficulties in a relationship: 'That looks on tempests and is never shaken' • again, the durability of love in a relationship is illustrated with the metaphor 'not Time's fool' showing that a loving relationship is not limited or tricked by time, even though looks may have changed as the end of life approaches • the 'sickle's compass' is linked to the idea of death and the image of the 'Grim Reaper' • love will last even in extremes, 'even to the edge of doom' • the conventional Shakespearean sonnet structure ends with the rhyming couplet in which Shakespeare offers a challenge to his readers, saying that, if his thoughts about love are wrong and love is not enduring, then he has 'never writ' or no 'man ever loved'. <i>Sonnet 116 and one other poem</i> Both poems have particular merits and features and therefore there are a number of points of comparison which candidates will make. Examiners might consider the following areas of comparison where applicable: treatment of subject matter and theme, tone, voice, attitude, character, diction, imagery including figurative language, poetic form/structure including rhythm, line length, enjambement. All points of comparison should be developed and supported by close reference and evaluation of specific examples.

	(AO3) Responses may include: - the poem chosen must be one in which a loving relationship is significant, such as <i>Piano</i>, <i>La Belle Dame sans Merci</i>, <i>Poem at Thirty-Nine</i>, <i>Do not go gentle into that good night</i>, <i>Remember</i>, or any other appropriate poem from the collection - the similarities and differences of subject matter in each poem will be considered - comparative links made between techniques, such as specific comparisons made in relation to language, and supporting these points with relevant evidence from the two poems, will be evident - comparisons and comments will be made on the use of form and structure - comparisons of how the two poems affect the reader may be considered. These examples are suggestions only. Accept any valid responses.
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Level	Mark	AO2 Analyse the language, form and structure used by a writer to create meanings and effects. (15 marks) AO3 Explore links and connections between texts. (15 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–6	- The response is simple and the identification of language, form and structure used by the writer is minimal. - There is little or no comparison of the two poems. - Limited use of relevant examples in support.
Level 2	7–12	- The response may be largely descriptive, with some comment on the language, form and structure used by the writer. - There are some underdeveloped comparisons and contrasts presented, with obvious similarities and/or differences between the poems. - Some use of relevant examples to support the response. NB: the mark awarded cannot progress beyond the top of Level 2 if only ONE poem has been considered.
Level 3	13–18	The response shows an understanding of the range of language, form and structure used by the writer and links these to their effect on the reader. The response compares and contrasts a range of points and considers some similarities and/or differences between the poems. Use of clearly relevant examples to support the response.
Level 4	19–24	The response is focused and detailed, and the analysis of the language, form and structure used by the writer and their effect on the reader is sustained. The response compares and contrasts the poems effectively, considering a wide range of similarities and/or differences between the poems. Use of fully relevant examples to support the response.
Level 5	25–30	The response is a cohesive evaluation of the interrelationship of the language, form and structure used by the writer and their effect on the reader. The response compares and contrasts the poems perceptively with a varied and comprehensive range of similarities and/or differences between the poems. Discriminating use of relevant examples to support the response.

Section C – Modern Prose

Question number	Indicative content
4 <i>To Kill a Mockingbird</i>	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the text. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) - the Radleys are significant because the family brings mystery to the novel, highlights the symbolism of mockingbirds and is central to Scout's and Jem's maturation. The family includes Arthur (Boo) Radley, Nathan Radley (who returns home from Pensacola) and old Mr and Mrs Radley. The Radleys are described as 'foot-washing' Baptists who keep themselves to themselves and do not go to church or socialise - the Radley Place is a significant location in the novel, as it is the home of the reclusive and notorious Radley family. The Radley house is 'three doors south' of the Finch family home and, unlike others, it has closed shutters and has not been maintained. It is shaded by the surrounding oak trees and its fence is falling down: 'remains of a picket drunkenly guarded the front yard'. Weeds and rubbish fill the yard and the shingles are 'Rain-rotted'. The property is unwelcoming and Scout is too afraid to go near it owing to the 'unknown entity' that lives there - myths surround the Radley Place. Jem claims that Boo Radley eats 'raw squirrels'. This and other rumours mean that a person 'would not pass the Radley Place at night, he would cut across the sidewalk opposite and whistle as he walked'. Children in particular are afraid to go anywhere near the house: 'A baseball hit into the Radley yard was a lost ball and no questions asked' - the mystery of Boo Radley is significant. He has not been seen by anyone for fifteen years and is a focus of malicious rumour and gossip in the community. He is called Boo by the local children who fear that he is a 'malevolent phantom'. Readers learn that Boo was in trouble as a teenager in a gang with some Cunninghams. His father vowed to keep him out of trouble rather than see him go to the state industrial school with the other boys. Stephanie Crawford tells Jem about how Boo stabbed his father's leg with a pair of scissors and was locked up in the courthouse basement. He was taken home by his father who pledged to the judge that Boo would never get into trouble again. He has been virtually kept a prisoner in the Radley Place from that point on - Mr Radley only came out of the house for thirty minutes a day to pick up groceries and spoke to no one. Mrs Radley never mixed with anyone in the Maycomb community. When Mrs Radley died it 'hardly causes a ripple' in Maycomb, as the only time she was ever seen was when she

watered her cannas in the front garden. Calpurnia refers to the late Mr Radley as 'the meanest man ever God blew breath into'

- after Mr Radley died, Nathan Radley, Boo's older brother, moved in and took his father's place. He is as reclusive as the rest of his family and shoots at anything he thinks may be in their yard. He maliciously cements up the knothole in the tree where Boo has been leaving small gifts for Jem, Scout and Dill so that Boo can no longer interact with them
- Boo Radley is initially feared by the Finch children and Dill, who dare each other to go up and touch the Radley Place: 'In the eyes of Jem Finch, Boo was half man, half monster, all terror'. Gradually, the children realise that Boo is a kind man. Boo sews up Jem's trousers after he leaves them behind when they snag on the fence
- Boo is significant because he becomes the hero of the novel when he bravely leaves the house to save Jem and Scout from the murderous attack by Bob Ewell at Halloween. Boo kills Bob while protecting the children. He carries the injured Jem back home and the sheriff, Heck Tate, makes the decision to 'let the dead bury the dead' and reports that Bob fell on his own knife. Scout realises that for Boo to be the centre of attention would be 'sort of like shootin' a mockingbird'.

(AO4)

- the Radley family are contextually significant as they challenge the social mores of Maycomb. They do not attend church, but 'worshipped at home'. They keep themselves to themselves. The family keep their shutters closed on a Sunday, 'another thing alien to Maycomb's ways'
- Lee was inspired to include the Radley family from her observations of a family that she lived near in Monroeville. Lee's neighbours kept their house boarded up and their son hidden inside for 24 years after he fell into trouble with the law
- the novel is set in the southern American states in the 1930s. Maycomb society was divided both racially and socially. The treatment of 'mockingbird' characters, such as Boo and Tom Robinson, is part of Scout's learning and education about life, injustice and the racism of the time
- the story is told from Scout's point of view as an adult looking back on her childhood and expresses nostalgic and critical comments about the isolated community of Maycomb in the 1930s. When the novel was written in the late 1950s (first published in 1960), people were becoming more aware of social injustices.

Level	Mark	A01 Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of the texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement. (20 marks) A04 Show understanding of the relationships between texts and the contexts in which they were written. (20 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–8	• Limited knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is simple with little evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • There is little comment on the relationship between text and context. • Limited use of relevant examples in support.
Level 2	9–16	• Some knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is largely narrative with some evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • There is some comment on the relationship between text and context. • Some use of relevant examples in support.
Level 3	17–24	Sound knowledge and understanding of the text. The response shows relevant personal engagement and an appropriate critical style. There is relevant comment on the relationship between text and context. Use of clearly relevant examples in support.
Level 4	25–32	Thorough knowledge and understanding of the text. The response shows thorough personal engagement and a sustained critical style. There is a detailed awareness of the relationship between text and context. Use of fully relevant examples in support.
Level 5	33–40	Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. Understanding of the relationship between text and context is integrated convincingly into the response. Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.

Question number	Indicative content
5 <i>To Kill a Mockingbird</i>	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the text. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) - teaching and learning are central to the novel. The novel is of the bildungsroman genre: a journey of innocence towards maturity. Throughout the novel, we follow Scout's and Jem's moral education and the children's progression from childhood innocence - when Scout begins school, her teacher, Miss Caroline Fisher, recognises that she is intelligent but suggests that Atticus should stop teaching Scout to read and that she will 'try to undo the damage' - Walter Cunningham, one of Scout's peers at school, refuses to borrow money for his lunch and this eventually leads to a fight. When Scout explains Walter's situation to Miss Caroline, the teacher learns more about Maycomb society but finds this situation difficult to comprehend - Calpurnia teaches Scout lessons in social manners and politeness, but Scout remains bored at school - when Walter goes to the Finch's house for lunch, Scout learns a life-lesson from Calpurnia, who warns her about how she should treat guests and how she should not judge people - Scout admits that she has learned a great deal: 'there wasn't much else left for us to learn, except possibly algebra' - Atticus gives the children advice about how to use their shotguns. He tells them 'Shoot all the blue jays you want, if you can hit 'em, but remember it is a sin to kill a mockingbird', which is a life lesson for the children - Miss Maudie echoes Atticus' views. She teaches the children that mockingbirds are not destructive; they do not do anything wrong and only make nice music for others to enjoy - Aunt Alexandra tries to teach Scout the value of being a lady - Atticus teaches the children the importance of seeing things through other people's points of view, and teaches them the meaning of courage and tolerance, such as when he talks about Mrs Dubose and how brave she is - the children learn about racism at Tom's trial and must learn self-control, when Atticus is insulted and called derogatory terms for fighting Tom's case. (AO4) - the first few chapters are collectively called 'Lessons the Children Learn', although the children's learning continues throughout the novel - the treatment of the mockingbird characters is part of Scout's learning and education about life. Scout learns about the injustice and racism of the time - Miss Caroline is committed to education, although her methodology is not as effective as that of Atticus. He teaches sympathy and understanding. The

	education system of the 1930s, not allowing for individual thought, is called into question by the writer - Miss Gates teaches the class about the importance of democracy and contrasts her belief that America is non-prejudiced with Hitler's persecution of the Jews. Despite Miss Gates' shock about the treatment of Jews, it is ironic that she too is racially prejudiced when Scout overhears her derogatory comments when leaving the courthouse - the novel reflects society, justice and injustice of the time. Maycomb is a microcosm of American society in the southern states during the Great Depression.
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Level	Mark	AO1 Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of the texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement. (20 marks) AO4 Show understanding of the relationships between texts and the contexts in which they were written. (20 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–8	- Limited knowledge and understanding of the text. - The response is simple with little evidence of personal engagement or critical style. - There is little comment on the relationship between text and context. - Limited use of relevant examples in support.
Level 2	9–16	- Some knowledge and understanding of the text. - The response is largely narrative with some evidence of personal engagement or critical style. - There is some comment on the relationship between text and context. - Some use of relevant examples in support.
Level 3	17–24	Sound knowledge and understanding of the text. The response shows relevant personal engagement and an appropriate critical style. There is relevant comment on the relationship between text and context. Use of clearly relevant examples in support.
Level 4	25–32	Thorough knowledge and understanding of the text. The response shows thorough personal engagement and a sustained critical style. There is a detailed awareness of the relationship between text and context. Use of fully relevant examples in support.
Level 5	33–40	Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. Understanding of the relationship between text and context is integrated convincingly into the response. Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.

Question number	Indicative content
6 <i>Of Mice and Men</i>	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the text. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) - the role of women is limited on the ranch. In the novel, women are given their place and have defined roles. Curley's wife is the only female character who interacts with the men on the ranch, but others are mentioned, such as her mother, Old Susy, Clara and the girls at the brothels, and Aunt Clara. Some candidates may consider Slim's dog, Lulu. Notably, Curley's mother is never mentioned - Curley's wife is the only main female character and, significantly, she is given no name. Her dream is to be in the movies and she tells Lennie 'I coulda made somethin' of myself ... Maybe I will yet' - when George and Lennie first meet Curley's wife, 'the rectangle of sunshine in the doorway was cut off', possibly symbolising her negative impact on the men - she is described as having 'full-rouged lips and wide-spaced eyes, heavily made up'. She has red fingernails and her hair hangs 'in little rolled clusters, like sausages'. Her mules have ostrich feathers on them. Her provocative appearance is unsuitable for life on a ranch and it unsettles the men. The care she lavishes on her appearance shows she has nothing else to do and no role on the ranch or in her marriage - Curley's wife's mother is portrayed by Curley's wife as being controlling and vindictive, yet she is most likely the opposite. Curley's wife tells Lennie that she has married Curley to escape her mother, whom, she believes, stole her letters offering a movie deal. The reader doubts that these letters were ever sent at all - when the men are speaking to, or about, Curley's wife, their comments are often offensive and vulgar; she is referred to as 'tart', 'rat-trap' and 'jail bait' - women are marginalised and receive little respect. The men regularly visit the local brothels at the weekend, including Curley who has only been married two weeks. Whit tells George that Old Susy is a laugh and that she has five girls there. Unlike the competing Clara's establishment, where they water down the drinks, Susy's 'place is clean' - after Lennie accidentally kills Curley's wife: 'the meanness and the plannings and the discontent and the ache for attention were all gone from her face'. Her death incites neither grief nor pity but rather anger on the part of Curley, who is more intent on pursuing his vendetta against Lennie than grieving - Lennie's Aunt Clara is mentioned briefly throughout the novel. George reminds Lennie of her when rebuking him. George tells Slim how he took care of Lennie when Aunt Clara died and about how she took Lennie in 'when he was a baby and raised him up'

- at the end of the novel, Lennie has a vision of Aunt Clara. She is described as 'a little fat old woman' with 'thick bull's-eye glasses' and 'huge gingham apron'. The vision berates Lennie for causing trouble for George and leaves Lennie beside himself with grief
- it is ironic that Slim's dog, Lulu, is named but Curley's wife is only a possession of her husband. Lulu appears to have more value on the ranch than Curley's wife.

(AO4)

- like the men on the ranch at a time of hardship and depression, Curley's wife wants to be part of the American Dream. She aspires to become an actress, a Hollywood star, as she confides to Lennie, but marries Curley when this dream fails. At the time, many women dreamed of being in the movies
- by calling her 'Curley's wife', Steinbeck indicates she is seen as Curley's possession. Like many women at the time, she is totally dependent on her husband. He refuses to let her talk to anyone on the ranch, isolating her from everyone, setting the stage for trouble when she seeks attention. She is lonely because she is a social outcast; she suffers from being isolated from other women
- despite a lack of status, women are higher in the social hierarchy than Afro-Americans. Curley's wife uses this knowledge cruelly to threaten Crooks: 'I could get you strung up on a tree so easy it ain't even funny'
- John Steinbeck wrote a letter to Claire Luce, the actress playing the part in the stage version of the novel. Steinbeck said that Curley's wife is essentially a good person who grew up 'in an atmosphere of fighting and suspicion' and that she has learned to use her sexuality as the only weapon she has to get her noticed.

Level	Mark	AO1 Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of the texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement. (20 marks) AO4 Show understanding of the relationships between texts and the contexts in which they were written. (20 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–8	• Limited knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is simple with little evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • There is little comment on the relationship between text and context. • Limited use of relevant examples in support.
Level 2	9–16	• Some knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is largely narrative with some evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • There is some comment on the relationship between text and context. • Some use of relevant examples in support.
Level 3	17–24	Sound knowledge and understanding of the text. The response shows relevant personal engagement and an appropriate critical style. There is relevant comment on the relationship between text and context. Use of clearly relevant examples in support.
Level 4	25–32	Thorough knowledge and understanding of the text. The response shows thorough personal engagement and a sustained critical style. There is a detailed awareness of the relationship between text and context. Use of fully relevant examples in support.
Level 5	33–40	Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. Understanding of the relationship between text and context is integrated convincingly into the response. Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.

Question number	Indicative content
7 <i>Of Mice and Men</i>	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the text. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) - the novel revolves around the working environment of a ranch. Different characters have various roles on the ranch that help to define them. Slim is the respected 'jerkline skinner', while Candy is the 'old swamper', Crooks is the stable buck and George and Lennie are tasked with 'bucking barley'. These roles contribute to the portrayal of their characters and emphasise how important it is to find and keep work - life on the ranch involves hard work and the men simply exist day-to-day. The majority of men are itinerant farm labourers and, although they lack privacy, they keep themselves to themselves. As Candy says 'A guy on a ranch don't never listen nor he don't ast no questions' - the layout of the bunkhouse is described as being regimented with 'eight bunks, five of them made up with blankets'. Personal or necessary items are stored in apple boxes converted into shelves: 'And these shelves were stocked with little articles, soap and talcum powder, razors and those Western magazines ranch men love to read and scoff at and secretly believe' - like many, Lennie and George are itinerant workers because of the effects of the Great Depression and that is how the reader finds them at the beginning of the novel, on their way to start work at the ranch. Luck seems to be against them from the very start, as the bus driver gives them 'a bum steer' - labourers have to obtain a work slip from an employment agency. George and Lennie have work slips from Murray and Ready's but, because of the bus driver, arrive late - the boss is very much in control of the men's futures. As there is a surplus in the workforce, he can afford to get rid of anyone he does not like. When George and Lennie arrive and meet him before starting work, the boss is abrupt with them and admonishes them for being late. His whole demeanour is authoritative and he interrogates them about where they have been and what their relationship is - Lennie's skill at manual tasks and his incredible strength represent his value to the ranch. George proudly speaks of his skills and is keen to present Lennie in a good light: 'He can rassel grain bags, drive a cultivator. He can do anything ... He can put up a four hundred pound bale'. Even Slim is impressed with Lennie: 'I never seen such a worker. He damn near killed his partner buckin' barley' - Slim is the 'prince of the ranch', enjoying an easy authority over the men who work for him. As the jerkline skinner, a very skilled job on the ranch, he is respected by everyone, and even Curley will not provoke him. Slim's authority extends beyond the working life of the ranch: he is called upon to adjudicate

in the bunkhouse over the fate of Candy's old dog, which Carlson wants to shoot. His tacit agreement that it should be put down is accepted by all, including Candy

- Steinbeck describes what the ranch is like as a workplace through a number of locations, such as the harness room where Crooks lives with 'a little bench for leather working tools'. He describes the superficial camaraderie in the bunk house amongst disparate individuals brought together by the need for work
- Curley's wife has no job and therefore no perceived identity. She dreams of being an actress but her lack of purpose and function contributes to her isolation and unhappiness. She falls into her role as Curley's wife on the very evening she hopes to take the first step in her future as an actress. After this, she is given no identity of her own, always referred to as 'Curley's wife'
- in their spare time the ranch hands play cards and horseshoes, and on Saturday nights visit the local 'cat house'
- Candy wants to be useful but the loss of his hand in an agricultural injury makes this difficult and he worries about being destitute and put out 'on the county'. Candy speaks of his likely fate when he is no longer able to work on the ranch: 'I got hurt four years ago' and 'They'll can me purty soon'. His goal in the dream is to be with George and Lennie, do some hoeing in the garden, and 'cook and tend the chickens'
- the fragility of employment and the threat of losing a job are evident throughout the novel. When Lennie 'busts' Curley's hand, George's concern is that the two will be 'canned', but Slim is able to persuade Curley not to say anything.

(A04)

- the reader sees the everyday life of itinerant ranch workers during the 1930s. During the time of the Great Depression, work was scarce. Itinerant farm labourers desperately sought work and travelled large distances. They had very few rights and very little pay. Itinerant farm labourers had to obtain government work slips in order to work, as George and Lennie have done from Murray and Ready's
- the farm labourers were fully aware that they could be easily 'canned' at any time. Life on the ranch involves long working days as well as hard labour
- George's and Lennie's dream revolves around the security of a permanent home and self-employment: 'An' it'd be our own, an' nobody could can us'. The American Dream is evident as Steinbeck presents the popular belief that independence and happiness are possible for anyone if they work hard
- the hierarchy of the ranch meant that everyone had a place and most characters were subjected to the authority of someone above them
- there was little appropriate provision for the old or disabled members of society, so all people had to work. Candy knows that once he has been 'canned' he will have nowhere to go. Similarly, if Lennie did not have George to look after him, he would be put in a 'booby hatch'.

Level	Mark	AO1 Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of the texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement. (20 marks) AO4 Show understanding of the relationships between texts and the contexts in which they were written. (20 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–8	• Limited knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is simple with little evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • There is little comment on the relationship between text and context. • Limited use of relevant examples in support.
Level 2	9–16	• Some knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is largely narrative with some evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • There is some comment on the relationship between text and context. • Some use of relevant examples in support.
Level 3	17–24	Sound knowledge and understanding of the text. The response shows relevant personal engagement and an appropriate critical style. There is relevant comment on the relationship between text and context. Use of clearly relevant examples in support.
Level 4	25–32	Thorough knowledge and understanding of the text. The response shows thorough personal engagement and a sustained critical style. There is a detailed awareness of the relationship between text and context. Use of fully relevant examples in support.
Level 5	33–40	Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. Understanding of the relationship between text and context is integrated convincingly into the response. Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.

Question number	Indicative content
8 <i>The Whale Rider</i>	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the text. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) - the cyclical nature of time is central to the novel and highlights the importance of how nature and man are connected. The four main sections are named after the seasons. Normal time can be traversed, as shown by the bull whale and Paikea. The passage of time is seen through the generations and Kahu's story - the Prologue begins with the backstory, 'In the old days'. Nature's cycle is described as 'Waiting. Waiting for the seeding. Waiting for the gifting. Waiting for the blessing to come' in the form of the Ancients, and 'the sun rose and set, rose and set' until the arrival of Kahutia Te Rangi, renamed Paikea - the bull whale's story traverses time and covers hundreds of years. His story begins with Paikea riding him to land. Later, he travels the oceans with his herd and is nostalgic for the past and his memories of Paikea. At the end of the novel, the bull whale 'began to lose his nostalgia for the past and to put his thoughts to the present and future' - the legend of Kahutia Te Rangi, or Paikea, also traverses time. When Paikea throws his last spear, he throws it into the future to be 'the one to flower when the people are troubled and it is most needed'. This is the spear that Rawiri believes that he sees 'flying through the air' when he helps bury Kahu's birth cord. Rawiri sees this as a good omen for the future - when working on the plantation in Papua New Guinea, Rawiri recognises nature's power and how, in time, nature will reclaim the land unless it is tended and man works with it: 'Man might carve his mark on the earth, but unless he's vigilant, Nature will take it all back' - the passage of time is seen through the different generations. Koro is desperate to preserve Maori culture and traditions in a time that is rapidly changing. He spends time with Porourangi, preparing him as his successor and trying to balance the dynamics of tradition and modernity - the story of Kahu begins with her birth and ends with a near-death experience. This passing of time explores how Kahu embraces her Maori culture and has an affinity with the sea creatures. She knows that Koro believes that, if the bull whale dies, the tribe will cease to exist: 'When it dies, we die. I die'. (AO4) - Maori customs and traditions are central to the novel and are what Koro is desperate to preserve. The burying of Kahu's afterbirth is one custom that creates tension between Koro and Nanny

	- the novel is structured in four sections: Spring, Summer, Autumn and Winter. The seasons represent the passing of time, the journeys made, the lessons learned, and echo the cyclical nature of the novel - when Koro learns that he has a granddaughter, he is disappointed and 'won't have anything to do with her'. He cannot 'reconcile his traditional beliefs about Maori leadership and rights with Kahu's birth'. Koro is the head of the male-dominated Maori society and guardian of the Maori customs, language and beliefs of the time. Koro hopes that Porourangi will 'have a son next time' - Maori have a number of legends that explain aspects of their past. These legends are passed down from generation to generation by tribal leaders or priests, such as Koro. Kahu was banished from these classes, as Maori culture at the time dictated that females were unworthy of leading the tribe. Kahu proves otherwise and challenges gender roles - the novel is in the Magical Realism genre: a style of art or literature that depicts fantastic or mythological subjects in a realistic manner.
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Level	Mark	AO1 Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of the texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement. (20 marks) AO4 Show understanding of the relationships between texts and the contexts in which they were written. (20 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–8	- Limited knowledge and understanding of the text. - The response is simple with little evidence of personal engagement or critical style. - There is little comment on the relationship between text and context. - Limited use of relevant examples in support.
Level 2	9–16	- Some knowledge and understanding of the text. - The response is largely narrative with some evidence of personal engagement or critical style. - There is some comment on the relationship between text and context. - Some use of relevant examples in support.
Level 3	17–24	Sound knowledge and understanding of the text. The response shows relevant personal engagement and an appropriate critical style. There is relevant comment on the relationship between text and context. Use of clearly relevant examples in support.
Level 4	25–32	Thorough knowledge and understanding of the text. The response shows thorough personal engagement and a sustained critical style. There is a detailed awareness of the relationship between text and context. Use of fully relevant examples in support.
Level 5	33–40	Assured knowledge and understanding of the text.

		The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. Understanding of the relationship between text and context is integrated convincingly into the response. Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.
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Question number	Indicative content
9 <i>The Whale Rider</i>	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the text. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) • Kahu has a close relationship with most members of her family, but the one she longs to have the closest relationship with, her great-grandfather, Koro Apirana, is not fully established until the end of the novel • Kahu has a good relationship with her father, Porourangi, although she appears to have a closer bond with her uncle, Rawiri. Kahu's mother, Rehua, dies when Kahu is three months old. Porourangi brings his wife's body to Whangara to be buried, but Rehua's mother takes Kahu to live with her. Kahu continues living with 'Rehua's folks', and it is not until she is six years old that she returns to Whangara to live with her father and his new wife, Ana • Kahu's relationship with Nanny (Nani) Flowers, her great-grandmother and Koro's wife, is very close. Nanny looks after Kahu and spends much of her time trying to persuade her husband to accept her. Nanny is protective and supportive of Kahu • Koro Apirana's relationship with Kahu is one of rejection and disappointment, as he wants a great-grandson to become a future chief of the tribe. He rejects Kahu as she is female and he believes she cannot be his successor as tribal chief • Koro is upset that his great-granddaughter is named Kahutia Te Rangi (Kahu). He believes this should be a male heir's name and he refuses to take part in the custom of burying Kahu's afterbirth, so Nanny Flowers arranges this herself • despite Kahu's idolisation and adoration of Koro, he still rejects her. Kahu does everything in her power to learn her tribal history, customs and language in order to make her great-grandfather proud of her. She secretly listens to Koro teaching the boys. However, later Koro fails to attend Kahu's break-up ceremony and the recital of his <i>whakapapa</i> • Kahu and Rawiri have a loving relationship. Rawiri is the narrator of the story. He is 16 years old at the beginning of the novel. A close relationship is established when Rawiri is appointed one of Kahu's guardians by Nanny, and he helps her to bury Kahu's afterbirth in the grounds of the <i>marae</i>, the Maori tribe's sacred meeting area • the close bond between Kahu and her uncle grows. Rawiri takes the two-year-old Kahu to the cinema to see a film about whales. On their way home, they spot some orcas in the sea and Rawiri is amazed when Kahu calls out and warns them to swim away. When she is three years old, Rawiri takes her sheep-shearing and she becomes a mascot for him and the other boys

- Kahu lovingly cleans Rawiri's motorbike every week whilst he is away. Rawiri is so touched by this that he cries. Later, when Rawiri is talking to Nanny, they agree that Kahu is beautiful both 'inside and outside. She had no guile. She had no envy. She had no jealousy'
- Nanny's bond with Kahu is evident, especially at the end, when Nanny collapses with shock on Kahu's being taken out to sea by the whale. Nanny spends five days recovering and cries with relief when she discovers that Kahu has survived
- after Kahu rides the bull whale, and the family realise that she could have died, Koro learns to appreciate that Kahu is a natural leader and realises his mistakes, declaring his love for his great-granddaughter.

(AO4)

- as narrator, Rawiri is sympathetic to the female Kahu and comments 'it was Kahu's intervention which perhaps saved us all', demonstrating Kahu's value, even though female, to Maori society at the time
- Maori customs and traditions are central to the novel. The burying of Kahu's afterbirth is one custom that creates tension between Koro and Nanny Flowers
- the legend of Paikea (Kahutia Te Rangi) and Koro's desire and obsession for a patrilineal descendant determine his treatment of Kahu and the reactions of his wife
- strong-willed women, such as Nanny, live in a patriarchal society at this time. The role of women and their place in Maori society are challenged by Nanny and Kahu: current tradition dictates that a boy should be the leader of the tribe
- Nanny's real name is Putiputi, which means 'flowers' in the Maori language. Kahu is named after the tribal great ancestor Kahutia Te Rangi, who is later given another name, Paikea.

Level	Mark	AO1 Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of the texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement. (20 marks) AO4 Show understanding of the relationships between texts and the contexts in which they were written. (20 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–8	• Limited knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is simple with little evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • There is little comment on the relationship between text and context. • Limited use of relevant examples in support.
Level 2	9–16	• Some knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is largely narrative with some evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • There is some comment on the relationship between text and context. • Some use of relevant examples in support.
Level 3	17–24	Sound knowledge and understanding of the text. The response shows relevant personal engagement and an appropriate critical style. There is relevant comment on the relationship between text and context. Use of clearly relevant examples in support.
Level 4	25–32	Thorough knowledge and understanding of the text. The response shows thorough personal engagement and a sustained critical style. There is a detailed awareness of the relationship between text and context. Use of fully relevant examples in support.
Level 5	33–40	Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. Understanding of the relationship between text and context is integrated convincingly into the response. Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.

Question number	Indicative content
10 <i>The Joy Luck Club</i>	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the text. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) • money and wealth have had, and do play, an important role in the Chinese mothers' and their daughters' lives. Some of the Chinese mothers have experienced privileged lifestyles and some of the daughters are very successful; however, money and wealth do not bring them happiness • at the beginning of the novel, following the death of Suyuan Woo, the mothers at the Joy Luck Club want to pool their money to send her daughter, Jing-mei, to China to meet her half-sisters and fulfil her mother's lifelong wish of a family reunion. They give Jing-mei the money to travel to China with her father to meet them, for they know this is what Suyuan would want • in her early years in America, Suyuan has struggled to afford to buy a piano, or to pay for lessons, for Jing-mei. Suyuan cleans the teacher's house to pay for lessons but, despite her efforts, Jing-mei shows neither interest nor talent • before emigrating to America, Lindo Jong married Tyan-yu Huang, the son of a very wealthy family. The family made Lindo perform household chores and showed little interest in her during the years of betrothal before her marriage to their son; she was never fully accepted and was very unhappy. To escape the marriage without dishonouring her family, she played on her mother-in-law's superstition by telling her the double-ended candle had extinguished on their wedding night. This led to Lindo's being able to leave the marriage and travel to America • in America, Lindo marries Tin Jong and they have three children. Tin buys Lindo a 24-carat gold bracelet after the birth of each child. When Lindo has spare money, she buys herself more bracelets, as to her they symbolise her purity and refusal to be untrue to herself • Waverly Jong is a successful and wealthy tax accountant. She wears fashionable clothes and patronises expensive beauty salons; Waverly scorns those beneath her. She is unkind towards Jing-mei at dinner when she criticises her appearance and copywriting skills. Wealth and success do not appear to bring her happiness • the relationship between Lena St Clair and Harold is strained and money is one of the reasons for this. Lena provides money to start their architectural firm; however, Harold is selfish with their wealth and still insists that Lena pay half of the household bills

- Ying-ying St Clair is not impressed with her daughter's affluent lifestyle. Lena and Harold have created a stylish and artistic home, but Ying-ying believes it is poorly constructed and has weak foundations, both literally and metaphorically
- Ying-ying tells the story of her life and how she grew up in a wealthy Chinese family, unlike most of the other mothers, and married the wrong man. Despite Ying-ying's former wealth, she is worried that her daughter is following a similar fate and is suffering in a miserable marriage
- Lena St Clair is unaware of her mother's former wealth in China and chooses to believe that her father rescued her mother from an unhappy situation
- in China, Wu Tsing, a wealthy and insensitive merchant, raped An-mei Hsu's mother and forced her to become his fourth wife or concubine. An-mei's mother sacrificed her own life so that her children could live a life of privilege
- when living in America, An-mei visits her brother in China, taking money and gifts with her. She explains to Suyuan that 'her brother was so poor and they were so rich by comparison'; however, the kindness of An-mei and her husband, George, is abused and, on their return from China, they find themselves 'depleted of some nine thousand dollars' worth of goodwill'.

(AO4)

- Amy Tan and her friends formed their own version of the Joy Luck Club. They called it 'A Fool and His Money' and used the club as a forum where they exchanged investment tips
- Amy Tan was inspired to write *The Joy Luck Club* after listening to her own mother's stories about her life in China; the novel is set in San Francisco in the 1980s and the stories span a range of decades from the 1920s. Jing-mei's story mirrors Amy Tan's own experiences
- the mothers had emigrated to America at a time when immigration restrictions were eased and people were fleeing China because they were at war with Japan, the Second Sino-Japanese War (1937 to 1945)
- Suyuan Woo wants her daughter, Jing-mei, to be a renowned pianist prodigy, like Ginny Tiu whom she has probably seen performing on the Ed Sullivan Show.

Level	Mark	AO1 Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of the texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement. (20 marks) AO4 Show understanding of the relationships between texts and the contexts in which they were written. (20 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–8	• Limited knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is simple with little evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • There is little comment on the relationship between text and context. • Limited use of relevant examples in support.
Level 2	9–16	• Some knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is largely narrative with some evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • There is some comment on the relationship between text and context. • Some use of relevant examples in support.
Level 3	17–24	Sound knowledge and understanding of the text. The response shows relevant personal engagement and an appropriate critical style. There is relevant comment on the relationship between text and context. Use of clearly relevant examples in support.
Level 4	25–32	Thorough knowledge and understanding of the text. The response shows thorough personal engagement and a sustained critical style. There is a detailed awareness of the relationship between text and context. Use of fully relevant examples in support.
Level 5	33–40	Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. Understanding of the relationship between text and context is integrated convincingly into the response. Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.

Question number	Indicative content
11 <i>The Joy Luck Club</i>	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the text. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) - the relationship between Lindo Jong and her daughter, Waverly, is often difficult. Lindo teaches her youngest daughter to be strong and to hide her thoughts with 'invisible strength'. She provides Waverly with the opportunity to become a champion chess player and, later, a successful attorney, but Waverly begins to resent her mother's control - Waverly begins playing chess when her brothers receive a set for Christmas. She becomes a child prodigy at the game and is even featured in magazines; however, she resents how her mother boasts about her and, in defiance, stops playing chess - Waverly appears to be ashamed of her mother, 'I wish you wouldn't do that, telling everybody I'm your daughter', and tends to project her fears onto her mother. When Waverly has dinner with the parents of her fiancé, Rich Shields, she imagines her mother's hatred for him - despite her fears of her mother's disapproval and several failed attempts by Waverly to tell her mother about her engagement, when Lindo is finally told, she responds well and actually likes Rich - Lindo wants to provide her daughter with American opportunities but fears Waverly will lose her Chinese identity; she realises that the two cultures can never successfully combine - Lindo has some regrets naming Waverly after the American street where they live because she fears that Waverly is becoming too Americanised. Lindo is afraid that she will be forgotten by her daughter and granddaughter, Shoshana, but her fears are not justified - Waverly has much respect for her Chinese heritage and culture. However, she fears that if she goes to China she will not be able to return to America - both mother and daughter struggle with their own identities. Lindo learns that she has been changed by American culture through her relationship with her daughter; when Lindo visits China she is seen as a 'tourist' but appreciates that she can be true to her own desires and experience personal happiness in America. (AO4) - the interwoven narratives convey the challenges of different cultures and identity for both mothers and daughters - misinterpretations of language create some tension for Lindo and Waverly, such as when Waverly misunderstands her mother's story, mishearing 'Taiyuan' as 'Taiwan'; her mother corrects her: 'Now listen ...'

	• Lindo's experiences relate to marriage and divorce in China and show how she suffered a 'doomed' marriage when she recalls the memory of the traditional burning of a red two-ended candle • most women in the novel find their voices and strength. The mothers were often forced into arranged marriages and were in unhappy relationships. The daughters struggle to assert themselves and must learn to overcome their difficulties in life.
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Level	Mark	AO1 Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of the texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement. (20 marks) AO4 Show understanding of the relationships between texts and the contexts in which they were written. (20 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–8	• Limited knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is simple with little evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • There is little comment on the relationship between text and context. • Limited use of relevant examples in support.
Level 2	9–16	• Some knowledge and understanding of the text. • The response is largely narrative with some evidence of personal engagement or critical style. • There is some comment on the relationship between text and context. • Some use of relevant examples in support.
Level 3	17–24	Sound knowledge and understanding of the text. The response shows relevant personal engagement and an appropriate critical style. There is relevant comment on the relationship between text and context. Use of clearly relevant examples in support.
Level 4	25–32	Thorough knowledge and understanding of the text. The response shows thorough personal engagement and a sustained critical style. There is a detailed awareness of the relationship between text and context. Use of fully relevant examples in support.
Level 5	33–40	Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. Understanding of the relationship between text and context is integrated convincingly into the response. Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.

Question number	Indicative content
12 <i>Things Fall Apart</i>	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the text. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) • Okonkwo demonstrates both physical and mental strengths. His physical strength gains him respect and an elevated reputation across Umuofia. Okonkwo has strength of character, but his mental strength and determination lead to his downfall • the novel begins with Okonkwo gaining respect when he becomes the wrestling champion. He defeats Amalinze The Cat • Okonkwo is described as being someone who is noticed. He is 'tall and huge' and 'seemed to walk on springs' • he demonstrates mental strength when vowing to be the polar opposite of his father, Unoka. Okonkwo believes that his father was a coward as he could not bear the 'sight of blood'. Unoka was weak, wasteful and lazy. Okonkwo was ashamed of Unoka, who was the laughing stock of the village and, when Okonkwo was a child, one of his playmates called Unoka <i>agbala</i>, suggesting that he was womanly • Okonkwo overcompensates for his father's weaknesses and, as a result, gains a reputation for being a fierce warrior and is harsh in his treatment towards his wives and children: 'Okonkwo was ruled by one passion – to hate everything that his father Unoka had loved. One of those things was gentleness and another was idleness' • even as a young man, Okonkwo shows strength of character. He becomes a successful warrior and a wealthy farmer. He wins two titles for his 'prowess in two inter-tribal wars' and has 'two barns full of yams'. His strength of determination to overcome the stigma of his father's legacy leads to his becoming a wealthy, successful man with three wives • Okonkwo's strength and position is rewarded when the elders select him to be Ikemefuna's guardian. Although Okonkwo will not show affection, as it is a sign of weakness, he is very fond of Ikemefuna • however, in order to maintain his reputation of strength and manliness, Okonkwo takes part in Ikemefuna's murder, and even strikes the fatal blow

	• on his return from exile in Mbanta, Okonkwo is dismayed with how his village has changed and how the colonists have asserted their power. When he thinks his people will rise up and support him in war against the colonists, he beheads one of the white messengers. He is devastated when he realises that others are not going to fight alongside him, and his spirit is broken • despite vowing to be the opposite of his father, Okonkwo dies a shameful death when he commits suicide after he realises that he cannot save the village from the colonists • Okonkwo is the protagonist of the novel and a tragic hero. When the novel begins, he holds a position of power but his fear of weakness and failure leads to his eventual fall. In Igbo (Ibo in the novel) culture, his name reflects his personality as it implies male pride and stubbornness. It could be argued that, at the end of the novel, Okonkwo's weaknesses have made him little different from his father, Unoka. In the end, Okonkwo's actions have lost him his reputation and status. (AO4) • violence was a regular occurrence between tribes and inherent in Igbo tradition and culture. Unoka will not take part in any violence, which leads to his being called <i>agbala</i>. It was expected that men would show strength and win titles in battles, as Okonkwo does • beliefs and superstitions were central to Igbo culture. The commands of the Oracle or Priestess of Agbala were largely unchallenged. Ikemefuna is murdered when the Oracle commands. The order is not questioned. Obierika tries to warn Okonkwo against being the one who kills Ikemefuna and suggests that the gods will be angry with him, but Okonkwo does not listen to his friend's advice as he is determined to show strength of character • traditional Nigerian society and culture are contrasted with impending colonialism and Christian influences • Achebe wrote <i>Things Fall Apart</i> to present a more accurate portrayal of native African life and the effects of colonialism. The novel provides a different perspective to Conrad's <i>Heart of Darkness</i>.
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Level	Mark	AO1 Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of the texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement. (20 marks) AO4 Show understanding of the relationships between texts and the contexts in which they were written. (20 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
Level 1	1–8	- Limited knowledge and understanding of the text. - The response is simple with little evidence of personal engagement or critical style. - There is little comment on the relationship between text and context. - Limited use of relevant examples in support.
Level 2	9–16	- Some knowledge and understanding of the text. - The response is largely narrative with some evidence of personal engagement or critical style. - There is some comment on the relationship between text and context. - Some use of relevant examples in support.
Level 3	17–24	Sound knowledge and understanding of the text. The response shows relevant personal engagement and an appropriate critical style. There is relevant comment on the relationship between text and context. Use of clearly relevant examples in support.
Level 4	25–32	Thorough knowledge and understanding of the text. The response shows thorough personal engagement and a sustained critical style. There is a detailed awareness of the relationship between text and context. Use of fully relevant examples in support.
Level 5	33–40	Assured knowledge and understanding of the text. The response shows assured personal engagement and a perceptive critical style. Understanding of the relationship between text and context is integrated convincingly into the response. Discriminating use of relevant examples in support.

Question number	Indicative content
13 <i>Things Fall Apart</i>	Examiners should be alert to a variety of responses and should reward points that are clearly based on evidence from the text. This is not an exhaustive list but the following points may be made: (AO1) - friendships are significant in the novel. Okonkwo's friendship with Obierika is significant as, although the men often have contrasting views, Obierika supports his friend in life and death. Other notable friendships include Ikemefuna and Nwoye, Ekwefi and Chielo, and the friendly relationship between Okonkwo's three wives. Other friendships may be considered, such as Mr Brown's friendships with prominent clansmen - the relationship between Okonkwo and Obierika is significant throughout the novel as Obierika advises his friend. Obierika is a man who 'thought about things' whereas Okonkwo is more impulsive. Okonkwo values the friendship of his constant and loyal friend, even though they have contrasting views. Obierika does not believe in unnecessary violence and is receptive to new ideas: 'Who knows what may happen tomorrow?' - Ikemefuna is a 15-year-old boy who is sent from the village of Mbaino as a peace settlement. After Ikemefuna is brought to live in Okonkwo's compound, a significant friendship develops between him and Nwoye, Okonkwo's eldest son by his first wife. Nwoye is 12 years old when the story begins and he sees Ikemefuna as an older brother - Nwoye does not show any jealousy over Okonkwo's appearing to be closer to Ikemefuna. Ikemefuna has a positive effect on Nwoye, broadening his mind with outside perspectives - even though the friendship is strong, Obierika will not take part in Ikemefuna's murder, claiming that he has 'something better to do', and warns Okonkwo not to do so either. However, he comforts Okonkwo after Ikemefuna is murdered. Okonkwo can only sleep peacefully after talking with his friend - when Nwoye realises that his father has murdered his friend, Ikemefuna, he distances himself from him and his clansmen. He breaks away from Igbo traditions by becoming a Christian and changing his name to Isaac. Okonkwo believes that his son is lost and 'not worth fighting for' - Okonkwo is supported by Obierika when Okonkwo is exiled to Mbanta. Obierika stores and sells his yams for him. When in his barn, Obierika thinks about Igbo (Ibo in the novel) cultures and traditions, and ponders over the harsh punishment that Okonkwo has received for his inadvertent crime; he misses his friend - Obierika remains a loyal friend and visits Okonkwo and his family in Mbanta. During one visit, he tells Okonkwo about the murder of a white man in Abame, and how the white men have taken retribution by slaughtering villagers. On his second visit, he informs Okonkwo that Nwoye has converted to Christianity

- Ekwefi is good friends with Chielo, the priestess of the goddess Agbala. Chielo is a widow with two children and is fond of Ezinma, whom she calls 'my daughter' and even carries her on her back when she is ill
- Okonkwo's wives have a friendly relationship with each other. They protect each other from their husband's tempers and do not show any jealousy towards each other. When Okonkwo gathers medicines for Ezinma, the other wives comfort Ekwefi
- the first white missionary, Mr Brown, believes in compromise, understanding, and non-aggression between his followers and the clan. It is significant that he becomes friends with prominent clansmen and builds a school and a hospital in Umuofia
- after Okonkwo takes his own life, Obierika asks the Commissioner if his men can help him to take down Okonkwo's body. Obierika blames the Commissioner for the death of his friend.

(AO4)

- the friendships in the novel are set against the background of the ceremonies and rituals important in every aspect of the villagers' lives: eating, drinking, marriage, war, religion. Umuofia's priests and medicine men were feared by other tribes. When Okonkwo kills Ikemefuna on the order of the Oracle, the relationship between Ikemefuna and Nwoye ends
- the novel explores the importance of kinship, extended families, and their roles and responsibilities in Igbo culture
- Obierika's discussions with his friend, Okonkwo, explore Igbo customs and traditions. Obierika also discusses the use of magic and medicine with the other men. His actions illustrate these customs: he remembers how he had to abandon his twins in the forest owing to tribal traditions, and when he slaughtered two goats and gave one to his daughter's future in-laws. However, unlike Okonkwo, Obierika questions the Igbo traditions, culture and tribal law
- traditional Nigerian society is contrasted with the impending colonisation and Christian influences. These challenges do not destroy the friendship between Okonkwo and Obierika.

Level	Mark	AO1 Demonstrate a close knowledge and understanding of the texts, maintaining a critical style and presenting an informed personal engagement. (20 marks) AO4 Show understanding of the relationships between texts and the contexts in which they were written. (20 marks)
	0	No rewardable material.
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